



MONTHLY UPDATE

Open data: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-18 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

25 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CAPE VERDE · CHAD · COMOROS · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SOMALIA · TANZANIA · TUNISIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Benin

The Open Government Partnership action plan's co-creation opened this month, eighteen months after the country joined. The budget directorate published a [38-activity co-creation matrix naming for each step the responsible body, its partners, the funding source and an indicative deadline](#), running from the June 2025 ministerial order that established the national committee through preparation, departmental consultation and adoption to documentation of the process after December 2026, with activity 32 committing government to publish a what-was-heard, what-was-kept-and-why report alongside a matrix of reasoned responses. The plan itself is not adopted, and no consultation record or commitment text is published.

Burkina Faso

The finance ministry cited a [2025 Open Data Inventory score of 77 out of 100, first in West Africa and second in Africa](#). The inventory scores official statistics published online; the national open-data portal founded in 2015 still serves no catalogue.

Cape Verde

The fisheries ministry presented a [public Fisheries Information System giving structured access to data on landings, licences, catches, revenues, subsidies and the sector's legal framework](#) at the FAO fisheries committee, built under the fisheries transparency standard the country joined in 2023. No launch date, licence or update frequency is given.

Chad

Publication and access moved in opposite directions. The statistics archive [bars redistribution of microdata without written consent](#), which settles whether Chadian public data is open: it is published and it is not open. On the access side the media regulator [suspended applications to create online newspapers until further notice](#), against a record holding no freedom of information law at all.

Comoros

The statistics institute's [national microdata archive held fifteen datasets at 23 August, searchable by study with documentation and microdata](#), two of them added inside the year: the 2024 household living-conditions survey and the second agricultural census. Access to individual files requires registration rather than an open licence, and no open-data policy, licence or release calendar sits behind it. Nothing outside the statistical system publishes a dataset at all.

Djibouti

The account of the archive programme published on 3 August also [establishes that 126 years of the Journal officiel are digitised and published online](#). The account gives no date for when publication began.

DR Congo

The month's one open-data movement came from the central bank rather than from the state's open-data policy, which the repository still does not hold. The bank [relaunched its website on 14 August as a public economic-data portal carrying exchange rates, inflation, interest rates, statistics and indicators, with a currency converter and a search facility](#), its governor framing the site as part of a reform whose stated objectives include digitalising payments and automating control processes. It is a publication channel rather than a data release: no machine-readable download, licence or update schedule is stated, and the national data governance strategy remains **Not held**.

The gap the open-data portal does not cover was named from outside government. The national academy of sciences [called for a national policy on the management and security of environmental data, setting the absence against an observing network that carried more than 125 synoptic weather stations and 400 hydrometric stations in the 1960s, few of which still work](#). It is an academic call rather than a government commitment: no draft, sponsoring ministry or timetable exists, and the station counts are the study's own historical figures — which is itself the finding, since nothing more recent is published.

Gabon

Gabon was assessed again as [not meeting the minimum fiscal transparency requirements in the 2026 review, published 11 August 2026 for the period to 31 December 2025, which presses governments to publish and regularly update information on state financial obligations including those of major state-owned enterprises](#). Of 139 governments and one entity reviewed, 73 met the requirements and 67 did not.

Gambia

One measured position moved into the record. The Gambia [ranked third in sub-Saharan Africa on budget transparency in the 2025 open budget survey](#). Budget transparency and open data are different things: the survey measures what a government publishes about its own spending, and the record held still carries no dataset count or portal for The Gambia.

Ghana

The one open-data movement in the window is a system that exists and a commitment that cannot pay for it. The fisheries ministry and the national multi-stakeholder group built an online Fisheries Information System, launched at an ocean conference in June 2026, but [inadequate funding is constraining the 2024 Fisheries Transparency Initiative](#)

[commitment it sits under](#), with the minister pointing to part of a goods-and-services allocation and to unconcluded talks with Norway on reviving a development funding mechanism. A published system with no secured budget behind the disclosure regime is the familiar shape here, and the national open-data instrument remains **Not held**.

An air-quality system reached testing: [a national air quality data hub built at a university laboratory went through utility testing with the environmental agency](#), which is to own it once a sustainability plan is agreed.

Guinea

The country-specific assessment behind the 2026 fiscal transparency report is now [held in full](#), where the repository had previously carried nothing on this subject. It is a foreign government's judgement on its own criteria rather than a domestic disclosure, and it is the only recurring transparency measure the repository holds for this country — which is a statement about the gap as much as about the finding.

Liberia

The telecoms regulator's chairman declined at a 30 July press briefing to disclose the Authority's revenue, [saying he reports to the President. The Authority publishes industry data — its 2025 mid-year report puts the two operators' combined revenue at US\\$96.1m for the first half of 2025 against US\\$79.8m a year earlier — but its own licensing fees, spectrum charges, levies and numbering receipts remain unpublished as at 4 August 2026](#).

Libya

On 20 July the [National Committee for the Information for All Programme held its first meeting](#), established under Decision No. (50) of 2026 and chaired by the General Information Authority, taking a proposed roadmap, coordination mechanisms between national entities, and a mandate to represent Libya in regional and international forums.

The month's one dataset is a trial. On 12 August the acting industry and minerals minister [launched the trial version of a national digital mineral map](#), built on an SQL database covering roughly 1,200 ore and mineral indicators with digital geological maps at 1:250,000, framed as a national information base for exploration, resource management and investment. No access terms, licence or publication date is stated, so it is not yet open data in any sense a reader could test.

Madagascar

Madagascar's open data is institution-specific and has no policy over it. The National Assembly runs a [read-only interface serving five parliamentary datasets as JSON and CSV under an open licence, rate-limited to 60 requests a minute, its counters reading 163 deputies, 45 texts and 128 sittings](#). Against that, a [general portal is a reachable landing page with six undated category tiles and four unlinked project cards, naming no issuing institution, dataset count or licence, and credited in its footer only to a private vendor](#); the finance ministry's own portal does not resolve. No whole-of-government open-data policy or mandate is held.

Malawi

What the right of access yields was measured for the first time. A newspaper investigation found that [65 per cent of 30 respondents received no answer to an information request inside the statutory 15-day period and 46.7 per cent gave up, with non-response the most cited reason a request failed](#), and its own requests to ten public institutions — among them the Anti-Corruption Bureau, two ministries, the police and the revenue authority — produced the

information in no case. The human rights commission's access-to-information unit says it can only make recommendations. It is one publication's survey rather than an official series, and no state figure exists to set beside it.

Mali

Open data moved from absent to partial. The statistics institute [publishes an open data licence agreement](#) and held a national workshop in June 2026 on statistical data modelling and [migration to a second-generation open data portal platform](#). Both are the institute's, covering its own data rather than government data generally, and the repository still holds no dataset count, portal address or open-data policy instrument.

Mauritius

The central bank put its statistics on a standards-based platform. It [launched its statistical data platform on 3 September, built with monetary fund and development bank support on an open data platform with standardised statistical data and metadata dissemination, and stated as the first African central bank on that platform's second version](#). No dataset count, series coverage, licence or machine-readable access statement accompanies the launch — which for a platform whose point is machine-readable dissemination is the thing a user would check first.

Morocco

The open-data portal is operating with four published procedure volumes — [manuals for open-data officers and data managers](#), a [data-inventory methodology](#) and a [standards and formats manual](#) — and published datasets including a [1,028-entry start-up database](#). A steering committee of ten bodies was established in December 2019 and a readiness assessment carried out in 2020, whose report remains unheld. The portal's own dataset count, publication statistics and action plan are not held either.

Namibia

The environment ministry put a data platform where the country has no open-data policy at all. Its [Multilateral Environmental Agreements monitoring and reporting platform launched at N\\$12m in the week of 7 August](#), built with UNDP under a Global Environment Facility land-governance project to centralise environmental data for national reporting. No public access, dataset list, licence or publication rule is stated, so on the record held it is a reporting tool rather than open data — and the access-to-information statute that would give a citizen a claim on any of it remains enacted and uncommenced.

A second dataset arrived from outside government altogether. A privately built application [launched nationwide on 14 August taking public reports of more than thirty kinds of infrastructure and service-delivery fault onto a mapped national dataset, with automatic facial and licence-plate redaction](#). It is privately held: no user count, arrangement with any authority, or licence for the data is stated, which is the difference between a dataset and an open one.

Nigeria

The month's open-data movement is civil society's rather than government's. A civic-technology foundation [published a 2026-2030 strategy on 3 September to institutionalise participatory budgeting and subnational public-project tracking in 10 to 15 states, building on two existing platforms that let citizens monitor budget implementation and identify completed, delayed or abandoned public projects](#). No budget, funder, delivery timetable or state is named.

Government procurement went the other way: online, but not open. The procurement bureau's [submission portal](#) became mandatory for agencies while contract awards, prices and delivery stay unpublished, although the 2007 procurement Act and the 2011 freedom of information Act require award particulars to be.

Senegal

The national data archive is the only Senegalese public-data system that publishes how much its data is used: [4,808,203 views on the 2013 census, 24,422 on the 2024-2025 agricultural survey and 19,910 on the 2023 census](#), with access stated per dataset as either licensed or withheld. Views are not downloads, and a licensed and partly withheld catalogue is not an open-licence portal — which is the finding, since no whole-of-government open-data portal operates behind it.

Somalia

The national research and education network [set up Somalia's first DataCite national consortium, letting universities and research centres mint persistent identifiers for more than 30 types of research output and data](#). No member count is published.

Tanzania

An external assessment found the country [not meeting the minimum fiscal transparency requirements](#) over a review period running to the end of 2025, the same finding as the previous review. It is the only recurring transparency measure the repository holds here, and it is a foreign government's criteria rather than a domestic one.

Tunisia

The national public data registry [is confirmed live and enabling citizen data requests, in an independent reporting-mechanism report on the country's open-government commitments](#). Confirmation by an external reviewer is a stronger record than a launch announcement, and no dataset count, request volume or response-time figure accompanies it.

Where the state does not count, others do: a civil-society organisation [announced a femicide data platform for launch on 12 August](#). No official series on the same subject is held.

Zimbabwe

A [national data commons was announced on 4 August](#) for public institutions, industry and researchers to share anonymised datasets, with selected government datasets stated to become publicly accessible within six months. No governing rule, dataset list or portal is held.

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